

Check our [Biosecurity Import Conditions system \(BICON\)](#) for biosecurity import conditions and imported [food safety requirements](#).

All biosecurity import conditions must be met before imported food safety requirements apply.

Food type

Herbs that are:

- fresh
- frozen
- dried
- powdered.

Exclusions

- Garlic flakes or granules.
- Preserved or retorted herbs.
- Food from [New Zealand](#).

Inspection and testing

This food is classified as a [surveillance food](#).

We refer consignments for analytical testing at the rate of 5%. During inspection we will also conduct a visual and label assessment.

Details on inspection and analytical testing can be found in the [BICON food safety requirements](#) case for ‘Herbs and spices’.

Table 1 shows the test that will be applied and permitted results.

Table 1, Test applied and permitted result

Food type	Test applied	Permitted result
Fresh/chilled or frozen herbs	Fruit and vegetable residue screen	The Food Standards Code lists maximum residue limits in Schedule 20 and extraneous residue limits in Schedule 21 .
Dried herbs	Salmonella	n=5, c=0, m=not detected in 25g

n = the minimum number of sample units that must be examined from a lot of food.

c = the maximum allowable number of defective sample units.

m = the acceptable microbiological level in a sample unit.

Fruit and vegetable residue screen analysis

These are the chemical tests applied to fresh herbs.

- 2-phenylphenol
- azoxystrobin
- benalaxyl
- bitertanol
- boscalid
- captan
- carbendazim
- chlorothalonil
- cyproconazole
- cyprodinil
- dicloran
- difenoconazole
- dimethomorph
- fenarimol
- fenhexamid
- fludioxonil
- flusilazole
- hexaconazole
- imazalil
- iprodione
- kresoxim-methyl
- metalaxyl
- myclobutanil
- paclobutrazol
- penconazole
- procymidone
- propiconazole
- pyraclostrobin
- pyrimethanil
- quintozone
- tebuconazole
- thiabendazole
- triadimefon
- triadimenol
- trifloxystrobin
- vinclozolin

- chlorthal-dimethyl
- diphenylamine

- diuron
- linuron
- oxyfluorfen
- pendimethalin

- acephate
- azinphos-methyl
- bifenthrin
- bioresmethrin
- carbaryl
- chlorfenvinphos
- chlorpyrifos
- chlorpyrifos-methyl
- cyfluthrin
- cyhalothrin
- cypermethrin
- deltamethrin
- diazinon
- dichlorvos
- dicofol
- dimethoate
- disulfoton
- ethoprofos
- fenamiphos
- fenitrothion
- fenoxycarb
- fenpyroximate
- fenthion
- fenvalerate
- fipronil
- hexythiazox
- indoxacarb
- malathion (maldison)
- methamidophos
- methidathion
- methomyl
- mevinphos
- monocrotophos
- parathion-ethyl
- parathion-methyl
- permethrin
- phenothrin
- phorate

- phosmet
 - piperonyl-butoxide
 - pirimicarb
 - pirimiphos-methyl
 - profenofos
 - propargite
 - prothiofos
 - pymetrozine
 - pyrethrins
 - pyriproxyfen
 - spinosad
 - spirotetramat
 - tau-fluvalinate
 - tebufenozide
 - tebufenpyrad
 - terbufos
 - tetradifon
 - thiacloprid
 - thiamethoxam
 - trichlorfon
-
- aldrin and dieldrin
 - DDT
 - endosulfan
 - endrin
 - HCB (hexachlorobenzene)
 - HCH (BHC)
 - heptachlor
 - lindane

Version history

Date	Amendment details
22/05/2026	Added content for fresh or frozen herbs.
07/02/2024	Included sample unit size (25g) under Permitted result.
28/01/2022	First version of the webpage published on website.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/import/goods/food/type/herbs>